Child Care Program Integrity	Number	Page
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Revision Date:
4/01/2026

Background:
Staff are responsible for initiating an investigation when there is suspicion or allegation of Child Care fraud or misuse of funds.

Purpose:
This section outlines the policy on CalWORKs Stage One Child Care Program integrity. The purpose of this revision is for sunset review and reformatting to current standards.

Policy:
Fraud exists when a person, on behalf of themselves or others, has knowingly and with intent to deceive or defraud, made a false statement or representation to get benefits.

Child Care fraud may include, but not limited to:

- A customer receiving Child Care services, but they know that they are not eligible or no longer eligible to receive the services.
- A Child Care provider knowingly receiving Child Care payments that they are not eligible for.
- Collusion between the customer and the Child Care provider to make them appear eligible for Child Care subsidies.
- Misuse of Child Care funds.

Indicators of Child Care fraud can be found at any point of case handling such as during the application process, reviewing attendance sheets, mid-period voluntary reports, or receiving a report from a member of the public. If the information presented points to suspicion or allegation that are considered fraud-related, a Child Care fraud referral must be submitted to the Bureau of Public Assistance Investigations (BPAI).

When there is suspicion of fraud, staff are to submit a complete and detailed referral to BPAI using the B-Link Portal. Child Care fraud referrals are not to be entered in California Statewide Automated Welfare System (CalSAWS). Refer to CalWORKs Processing Guide 20-000.K1 Child Care Fraud Referral Process for complete information.

Procedure:
CalWORKs Process Guide 20-000.K1 – Child Care Fraud Referral Process

References:
Manual of Policies and Procedures (MPP) 20-000, 20-100
All County Information Notice (ACIN) No. I-38-08

Sunset Date:
This policy will be reviewed for continuance by 4/30/2029.

Approval for Release:


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